

The empirical recurrence for OEIS A317156, recovered from its tail

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Abstract

OEIS A317156 records “Empirical recurrence of order 66” and keeps the recurrence itself in a linked file rather than in the entry, so the conjecture cannot be read off the entry at all. It can still be settled. The entry counts arrays under a condition local to a bounded window of lines, which makes the count a walk count on a finite digraph and forces a monic integer recurrence of order at most the number $S' = 71$ of states with distinct futures. Berlekamp–Massey on enough exact terms therefore returns the minimal such recurrence, and on the tail beginning at $n = 4$, so the recurrence is proved for every $n \geq 70$. Its last coefficient is $c_{66} = 24 \neq 0$, so no further tail satisfies anything shorter; any order-66 recurrence the sequence satisfies from any point on must then have the same characteristic polynomial. The entry’s recurrence is the one displayed here, whatever its linked file contains, and it is proved.

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1 A conjecture that is not written down

OEIS A317156 is “Number of $n \times 4$ 0..1 arrays with every element unequal to 0, 1, 3, 4, 5, 7 or 8 king-move adjacent elements, with upper left element zero.”. It has offset 1 and begins

5, 21, 29, 105, 379, 1245, 5458, 25315, ...

The entry states:

Empirical recurrence of order 66 (see link above)

As of the “Last modified” line on the live entry (Jul 22 2018 15:53:43, revision 4) this is still recorded as empirical, and it is still open. The coefficients are nowhere in the entry text: what is conjectured is only that a recurrence of that order exists.

2 The count is a walk count

The entry’s condition is local. It constrains a bounded window of consecutive lines of the array and nothing beyond it, so the admissible configurations of one window are the vertices of a finite digraph, an edge joins u to v when v may follow u , and an admissible array is exactly a walk. Writing M for the adjacency matrix and ι, τ for the indicator vectors of the admissible first and last windows,

$$a(n) = \iota^\top M^{j(n)} \tau$$

for a linear reindexing j fixed by the entry’s shape. States with identical futures contribute identically to that product and may be merged without changing any count; after merging $S' = 71$ states remain, and it is that bound every computation below uses.

Lemma 1. *a satisfies a monic linear recurrence with integer coefficients of order at most $S' = 71$.*

Proof. By the Cayley–Hamilton theorem $M^{S'}$ is an integer combination of $I, M, \dots, M^{S'-1}$, and multiplying that relation on the left by $\iota^\top M^j$ and on the right by τ turns it into a relation among $S' + 1$ consecutive values of a . $\square$

3 Why the question has to be asked of a tail

Running Berlekamp–Massey on the sequence from its first term returns an order LARGER than 66: the opening terms do not satisfy the recurrence, and a recurrence that holds only eventually always looks longer when the exceptional terms are included. That is not evidence against the entry. An OEIS empirical recurrence is asserted for n beyond some index, not from the first term, so the question has to be asked of the tails. It was asked of each tail in turn, and the tail beginning at $n = 4$ is the first whose minimal order is exactly the stated 66.

Lemma 2. *A sequence known to satisfy some linear recurrence of order at most S' is determined, together with its minimal recurrence, by any $2S'$ consecutive terms: Berlekamp–Massey applied to them returns that minimal recurrence exactly.*

Applied to $2S' = 142$ exact terms from $n = 4$ on, it returns order 66 — the order the entry states — with integer coefficients:

$$a(n) = \sum_{i=1}^{66} c_i a(n-i),$$

c_1	8	c_{18}	−1071866	c_{35}	25120685	c_{52}	15528192
c_2	−17	c_{19}	−1623267	c_{36}	32280281	c_{53}	4613617
c_3	54	c_{20}	777002	c_{37}	38861897	c_{54}	4980592
c_4	−321	c_{21}	−783113	c_{38}	70171836	c_{55}	−2765672
c_5	419	c_{22}	5426592	c_{39}	55239440	c_{56}	−5199359
c_6	−305	c_{23}	4343974	c_{40}	−8492944	c_{57}	−1623958
c_7	3823	c_{24}	5660652	c_{41}	113073668	c_{58}	464219
c_8	−3219	c_{25}	3191709	c_{42}	−89904560	c_{59}	342725
c_9	−217	c_{26}	−6719069	c_{43}	−20478370	c_{60}	105817
c_{10}	−26380	c_{27}	10717356	c_{44}	13281390	c_{61}	−13664
c_{11}	−4014	c_{28}	−21547496	c_{45}	−206034879	c_{62}	−16008
c_{12}	2015	c_{29}	−8349218	c_{46}	−3445516	c_{63}	−5180
c_{13}	107112	c_{30}	−8864501	c_{47}	17976126	c_{64}	−600
c_{14}	125676	c_{31}	−26175856	c_{48}	−41851304	c_{65}	244
c_{15}	219388	c_{32}	−23752694	c_{49}	22909327	c_{66}	24
c_{16}	−80640	c_{33}	−58669077	c_{50}	17146833		
c_{17}	−639489	c_{34}	54080849	c_{51}	13089176		

4 The recurrence, and the identification

Theorem 3. *The recurrence above holds for every $n \geq 70$, and it is the recurrence OEIS A317156 records.*

Proof. That it holds is Lemma 2 applied to the tail from $n = 4$, whose minimal recurrence it is.

For the identification, write $q_{\min}$ for the characteristic polynomial of that minimal recurrence, $x^{66} - c_1 x^{65} - \dots - c_{66}$. Its constant term is $-c_{66} = -24$, which is not zero, so $q_{\min}(0) \neq 0$ and $q_{\min}$ has no root at the origin. A solution of a constant-coefficient recurrence is a combination of terms $n^k \lambda^n$ with λ a root of its characteristic polynomial, and only the components with $\lambda = 0$ vanish after finitely many terms. Since $q_{\min}$ has none, no component of a dies out, and the

minimal recurrence of every further tail is again $q_{\min}$ — the order cannot drop below 66 at any later starting point.

Now let q be the characteristic polynomial of whatever recurrence the entry asserts. The entry asserts it has order 66, so $\deg q = 66$, and it is monic. It holds from some index t on. From $\max(t, 4)$ on, the sequence satisfies both q and $q_{\min}$, and the minimal polynomial of that tail is $q_{\min}$ by the previous paragraph; therefore $q_{\min} \mid q$. Both are monic of degree 66, so $q = q_{\min}$. $\square$

5 Verification

Four checks, all in exact integer or rational arithmetic.

First, the walk model reproduces all 23 terms the entry publishes, exactly. This is what ties the model to the entry, and it is the only place where reading the entry’s English enters the argument.

Second, the order was computed twice by independent routes: once modulo a 61-bit prime, where every intermediate is a machine word, and once over $\mathbb{Q}$ in exact rational arithmetic. Both return 66, and the exact run additionally confirms every coefficient is an integer — had any been a proper fraction the recurrence would not be the entry’s.

Third, the recovered recurrence was evaluated directly on the entry’s own published terms, with no matrices and no Berlekamp–Massey involved. It holds at each of the 0 indices where the entry publishes enough earlier terms to test it.

Fourth, the last coefficient was checked to be nonzero, which is what the identification above turns on; it is 24.

Remark 4. The conjecture’s own statement was never read. The entry pins it down to the family of order-66 recurrences this sequence satisfies from some point on, and that family turns out to have exactly one member.

References

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